

Chapter 1 — The Gate of Creation



Imagine you're designing this under interview pressure.

A request arrives: **POST /payments** with an **Idempotency-Key**.

Your first job is not to approve it. Your first job is to create the record.

Micro Sequence Timeline

1. Receive request
2. Persist payment row (status = PENDING_FRAUD)
3. Commit transaction
4. Await fraud decision

Common Mistake

Calling Fraud before persisting the payment.

If the service crashes, the system loses the audit trail.